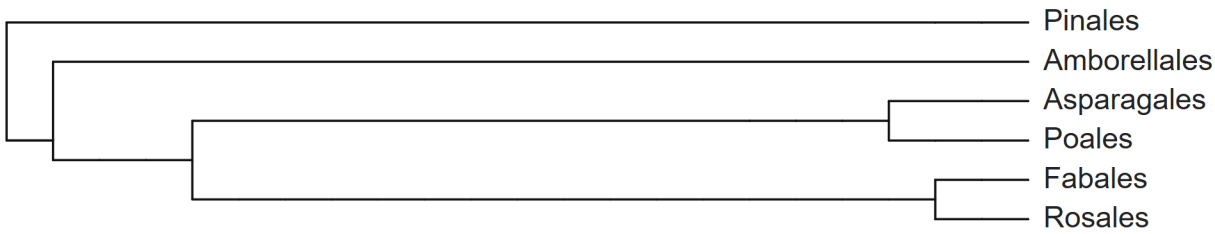
Creating an evidence-based illustration

Interpret a sampled source and write a caption that communicates evidence, selection and limits.

These terminal labels are plant orders, not species. Five flowering-plant orders and one represented gymnosperm outgroup are selected from the Kew release 4.0 order tree. Branch spacing is nonmetric.

Name: _____ Date: _____



Selected order records from Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew and collaborators, Tree of Life Explorer release 4.0; Baker et al. (2022). CC BY 4.0. Source bytes unchanged; selection and layout adapted for teaching.

Text description: Among the selected order records, Asparagales and Poales form a represented pair, as do Fabales and Rosales. Amborellales is another sampled flowering-plant order. Pinales represents a gymnosperm outgroup. Additional descendants are present in the complete source.

1. Identify the represented Asparagales/Poales and Fabales/Rosales groups by tracing their ancestors. What kind of records do these tip labels identify?

2. Does the drawing show all flowering-plant orders or all living plants? State one sampling limitation and one limit on interpreting branch lengths.

3. Write a short caption naming the source, the selected scope, one presentation modification, and the meaning of branch spacing.

Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew and collaborators. Tree of Life Explorer release 4.0 (2026), CC BY 4.0: creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/. Baker et al. (2022): 10.1093/sysbio/syab035. Activity text: 0BSD.